

use of the popularity of the original PlayStation and added backward compatibility to the PS2. Straight away, this meant the PS2 had a catalogue of hundreds of games even before it was released.

Another master-stroke was to add DVD playback. DVDs were just starting to come into their own, and the PS2 became an irresistible package with the ability to play games and view DVDs, for a price that was relatively cheap. This means that currently, worldwide sales for the PS2 stand at a whopping 90 million units. Coming in at a distant second is the Xbox, with a relatively meagre 19 million units.

Nintendo's GameCube is struggling to beat the PS2, with only 18 million units sold worldwide. That may be only one million units less than the Xbox, but considering that Microsoft was new to the industry and that they released their console after Nintendo did, they're not doing well at all.

This round of the console wars therefore again went to Sony.

Episode 6: This will feature the next generation of consoles—the PS3, the Xbox 360 and the Nintendo Revolution. The Xbox 360 is due for release in late 2005, and may gain a foothold in the market because of its early release. The PS3 is due for release only in mid-2006. The Xbox 360 is promising even better hardware than last time, as well as backward compatibility and a ton of new games with the biggest developers in the world. The PS3 is not far behind either, and will feature the Cell processor, supposedly a jaw-dropping 35 times faster than the PS2. It will also feature backward compatibility with PS2 and PS1 games.

Nintendo also seems to be considering innovation. Take for instance, their controller for the Revolution—it will be wireless, and motion sensors will allow a movement of the controller in the players' hand to translate into in-game movement. While it is too early to bet on one player for the next-gen console wars, Sony has to be favourite, simply considering their past record. Only time can tell for sure.